

Facebook's half billionaire

Facebook announced past week that it has reached 500 million active users around the world

PC control

Gmote is an application that converts your Android cell phone into a Remote control to control your desktop PC

Used with a compatible FX series of lens, it can be a joy for wildlife and sports photographer among others.

Canon EOS 1000D

The Canon 1000D has a strong body, but it lacks a rubberised grip. There is very little gap between the hand grip and the lens mount, such that your



Canon EOS 1000D

fingers will lock against each other while adjusting the lens at times. The layout of buttons around the screen is very neat. Navigating through the menus isn't overwhelming. It has a Liveview mode, but it doesn't have support for video shooting.

All in all this is a great camera for DSLR newbies to work around with, till they decide to graduate to the professional level. At a sweet price point of ₹25,295, it is highly economical.

Performance and final words

The Canon EOS 1000D and the Nikon D3000 lie at the bottom of the pyramid. They both come very close to each other in image quality. The colours on the EOS 1000D seem a little more saturated. Throw the D5000 into the

picture, and colour saturation on it seems a tad better. The D5000 on auto settings is a little better than the D3000 and Canon EOS 1000D. The 550D shares characteristics when it comes to colours and image sharpness with the costlier Canon EOS 7D.

When it was time to play with the Nikon D3s, it delivered what we expected it to. The highlight was its excellent performance in low light. It performs great till ISO 6400 sensitivity. At ISO 12,800, you need a tripod to get a sharp image. Noise is visible only at maximum zoom in most ISO's up to 6400. The test images we shot gave good colours and detail at 100 per cent zoom.

When we compared some of the shots of the Canon EOS 7D with the Nikon D300s, we found the colour saturation to better with the D300s. Image seemed softer on the Canon EOS 7D though. The cameras adjusted to the lightning and set very low ISO levels. Sensor noise was not an issue here.

With the four third system cameras, even the slight drop in sensor size results in a small drop in quality. Some grain is visible on the Olympus PEN series across all shots even when compared to the entry-level DSLRs.

Canon also arranged two additional lenses to play around with. One, the EF70-200mm f/4L USM zoom lens priced at ₹68,295. We used it with the EOS 7D and we found extremely handy at outdoor shoots. We weren't able to

HOW WE TESTED

All the test photos were taken using the automatic mode where the camera would set the best settings for the scenario and hopefully, take the best photos possible.

The test scene would contain a wide variety of objects and items that would be illuminated by pure white light to eliminate any possibilities of colouration. We ensured that the room was made pitch dark by covering all windows. All lights were turned off.

Three test shots were taken. The first one was the wideangle shot with no zoom used, the next with the zoom set to maximum and the third with the flash on. Each of these photos were compared with each other so we could rate the quality. We were looking for crisp images with properly focused objects and natural colours. We also rated the camera for their usability. Points were given for easy-to-use menus, quality of the body, dedicated controls, etc.

play around with it with the rain pouring down on us but anyone looking for a good lens for wildlife shoots, with a reasonable good camera such as the EOS 550D or EOS 7D should go for this lens. The other lens was the ₹61,995 EFS 15-85mm f/3.5-5.6 IS USM which makes for good wideangle shots but also can be used for some basic zoom similar to the 18-55mm kit lens.

We would highly recommend the D3S to anyone who is a serious full-time photographer. Our only concern is the pricing of ₹2,89,950 just for the body. You'll need to get compatible lenses to work on the camera though. It's our best performer with the EOS 550D getting the Best Buy award. As an all rounder, the EOS 550D is a great camera.

For enthusiasts like you and me, the Nikon D3000 will do just fine. You get the controls you always to play around with photography and you also get the improved quality. The Canon EOS 1000D is our

Best Buy winner. It maybe a little inferior in build and image quality, but at the price it's available at these days, it makes very good sense indeed. If you want video on your DSLR, then the slightly more expensive D5000 is an option to consider.

We weren't very impressed with the four third cameras. For one, the body may be compact but like most cameras, they come with zoom lenses which can't be compacted anymore. There's no way you can put one of these in your pocket unless you detach the lens. These cameras offer much improved image quality over point and shoots but not enough to match DSLRs. If we had to choose one from this format, it would be the Olympus PEN E-PL1. It's cheaper, but it shares a lot of characters with the E-PL1. If you're looking for ultimate quality from this format, then the Samsung NX10 wins. It's priced high at ₹42,990 though. It would be great if they were priced like ultrazoom cameras but they're not. They're often priced as much or higher than the basic DSLRs which people seem to going in for these days. Until we see those big drops in prices, things look bleak. **d**

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